Uliana Sirotina

ENGINEERING MANAGER | PEOPLE LEADERSHIP & HIRING | ENGINEERING CULTURE

Munich, Germany (remote/hybrid) | uliana.sirotina@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/usirotina/ | bulliana.com

Engineering Manager focused on people leadership, hiring and engineering culture, with 10 years in software engineering. As frontend hiring manager at Uberall, hired 13 engineers across all teams and kept the squad at zero attrition through an acquisition and a reorganisation. At SoSafe, promoted to lead within 4 months and led 8 engineers over 2 years through two team rebuilds. Technical depth to talk architecture; focus on performance, growth and how teams work together.

Experience

Engineering Team Lead (EM scope: line manager of 5) Apr. 2024 - present
SoSafe SE | Remote

Promoted from Senior Frontend Engineer to Team Lead within 4 months. Lead a cross-functional squad of 5 engineers (frontend, backend, fullstack) owning the Customer and User domains; 8 engineers led over 2 years, through two team rebuilds.

- **Turned an underperformer around in 7 months.** Coached a senior engineer out of underperformance through structured feedback.
- **Managed one exit end to end**, from calibration to separation.
- **Grew a QA engineer into backend.** Moved a QA engineer into a junior backend role and promoted him to mid-level in the next review cycle.
- Ran end-to-end hiring for 2 engineers and trained 3 colleagues to interview (including one first-time hiring manager) and authored hiring-process improvement proposals.
- **Made the team an early AI adopter** (first to volunteer for tool trials, 2-day AI hackathon, AI now fully rolled out) and connected the design system to Claude Design with our design system designer, enabling engineers, including backend, to design full UI/UX flows despite limited designer capacity; designed a Sales-facing test customer creation flow myself
- Built an **AI skill for calibration** and structured performance feedback, aligned to SoSafe's Engineering Levels Framework and reused by managers across the company
- Rebuilt the team from merged parts (new PM, new designer, two developer pairs from different squads) and distributed ownership until holding only 4 of 16 epics personally.
- Introduced sprint-based planning, velocity tracking and explicit prioritisation; deliberately halved sprint load to reinvest capacity into architecture, technical planning, bug triage and pairing.
- Delivered the 2-digit to 4-digit language code migration unblocking locale variants across 5 teams; blocked a shortcut implementation by quantifying the ~2 months per team of debt it would create.
- **Sized a seven-to-eight-figure annual recurring revenue impact.** Led the Claude-assisted technical investigation and director-level communication of a pricing incident affecting hundreds of customers, delivering root cause and a remediation plan to engineering and GTM leadership, then a joint provisioning audit with Product Analytics.

Senior Frontend Engineer Feb. 2023 - Mar. 2024
Garden.io GmbH | Berlin, Germany

- **Shipped free-tier onboarding on the fixed release date.** Designed and implemented the customer onboarding flow for the product's free tier launch, covering a gap found late in planning.
- Built product features in TypeScript, React, React Query and styled-components, with smaller improvements to the API.

Freelance Frontend Engineer Oct. 2023 - Feb. 2024
Trail | Remote
Part-time freelance, alongside employment at Garden.io.

- Frontend features in TypeScript, React, GraphQL/Apollo.

Senior Frontend Engineer Apr. 2022 - Jan. 2023
Adjust GmbH | Berlin, Germany

- Restructured the team's API error handling and separated Sentry reporting from the shared company project, improving signal quality for frontend issues.

- Introduced a bug board and triage flow for the team.

(Squad Lead) Engineering Manager Aug. 2020 - Mar. 2022
Uberall GmbH | Berlin, Germany

People lead for a cross-functional squad of 6 owning review management (aggregating Google Maps, TripAdvisor and partner reviews into one tool), and frontend hiring manager for the engineering department.

- **Hired 13 frontend engineers across all teams.** As the department's frontend hiring manager, built the frontend hiring process and its documentation, and trained other engineers to interview.
- **Zero attrition through an acquisition and a reorg.** Held the team together through repeated process changes: zero attrition over two years, with delivery cadence unbroken.
- Led a cross-functional squad of 6 owning review management: aggregating reviews from Google Maps, TripAdvisor and other partners into a single tool for customers to read, sort and respond to them.
- Promoted one engineer to Senior, and mentored a backend engineer from another team into their first Team Lead role, advocating for them with leadership to make it happen.
- Introduced Scrum from scratch to balance a defect-prone multi-partner ingestion pipeline against new product delivery: two-week sprints with capacity deliberately reserved for incremental fixes, so quality improved steadily without pausing feature work.

Freelance Frontend Engineer Dec. 2020 - Jan. 2022
Rebels AI | Remote

- Refactored a geology webapp and built a task-generator interface in React; direct client consulting.

Frontend Engineer Aug. 2019 - Jul. 2020
Uberall GmbH

- Developed features using ReactJS, Redux, React-Query, and Less, conducted code reviews.
- Improved onboarding documentation and process in the Engineering department.
- Led the creation of UI-component library (Theme UI, ReactJS).
- Organised and ran the Frontend Chapter meetings.

Frontend Engineer (joined as working student) Sep. 2016 - Jul. 2019
Searchmetrics GmbH | Berlin, Germany

- Created and maintained UI-kit (component library) - Storybook, ReactJS.
- Mentored frontend working students.

Education

M. Sc. Computer Science 2015 - 2018
Technical University of Berlin, Major: Media design and Human-computer interaction

Diploma, Cognitive Systems 2009 - 2014
Russian State University for the Humanities

Skills & Tools

People leadership: Line management, Performance management, Career development, Promotions, Managed exits
Hiring: Hiring process design, Interviewer training, Hiring decisions
Ways of working: Scrum, Sprint planning, Incident communication, Documented processes
AI: Claude, Claude Design, ChatGPT, AI skills and agents, team adoption and rollout
Technical background: TypeScript, React, Node.js | Led teams with Java/Kotlin backends

Additional info

2022 - Mentor Move - career and relocation mentor for specialists moving into European tech roles: CV reviews, mock interviews, coaching

Languages: English (C1), German (C1), Russian (native)
Unrestricted work permit, Germany